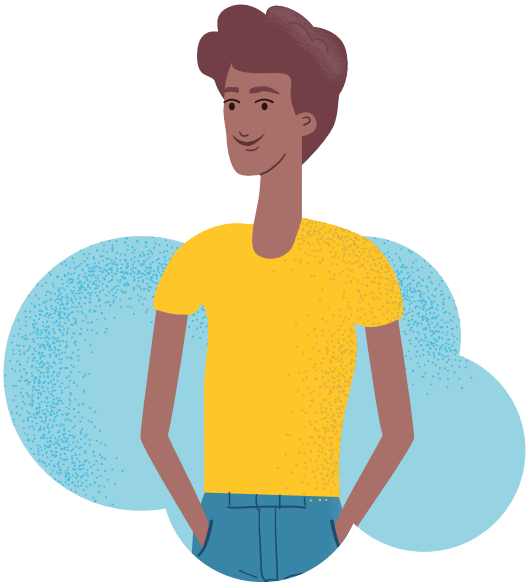
Core emotions and their physical expressions





Happiness

A pleasant emotional state brought on by positive connection and pleasure. In the workplace, happiness might be expressed through smiling at a coworker's joke, laughing during a team meeting, or displaying relaxed body language during a successful project.



Sadness

The opposite of happiness or enjoyment, most often caused by a loss of some kind. In the workplace, sadness might be expressed through frowning or crying after receiving negative feedback, displaying apathy or sluggishness during a low-performing project, or withdrawing from social interactions after a layoff or reorganization.



Anger

An emotion that typically arises when your progress toward some kind of goal is blocked or hindered. In the workplace, anger might be expressed through frowning or glaring at a coworker who undermines your ideas, aggressive postures or behaviors during a heated meeting, or speaking curtly or yelling when frustrated with a project or task.

Core emotions and their physical expressions



Disgust

An emotion that arises during encounters with something toxic or harmful. In the workplace, disgust might be expressed through physical avoidance or recoiling from a coworker who displays poor hygiene, wrinkling noses or curling upper lips when encountering a foul odor, or even gagging or vomiting in response to a particularly unpleasant task.



Surprise

A fleeting emotion in response to something startling and unexpected. In the workplace, surprise might be expressed through widening eyes and raised eyebrows during an unexpected promotion or raise, recoiling from the source of a sudden loud noise, or exclamations such as screams or gasps when encountering a surprising or unusual situation.



Fear

An emotion that arises when you encounter or anticipate threats or challenges. In the workplace, fear might be expressed through widening eyes and tensing muscles during a presentation, hiding or shrinking back during a difficult conversation with a superior, or heightened sensitivity to movement and noises when working in a high-stress environment.

Remember, emotions are complex and varied, and individual experiences and expressions can vary widely. However, by familiarizing yourself with these core emotions and their physical expressions, you can begin to improve your emotional perception and awareness in the workplace.